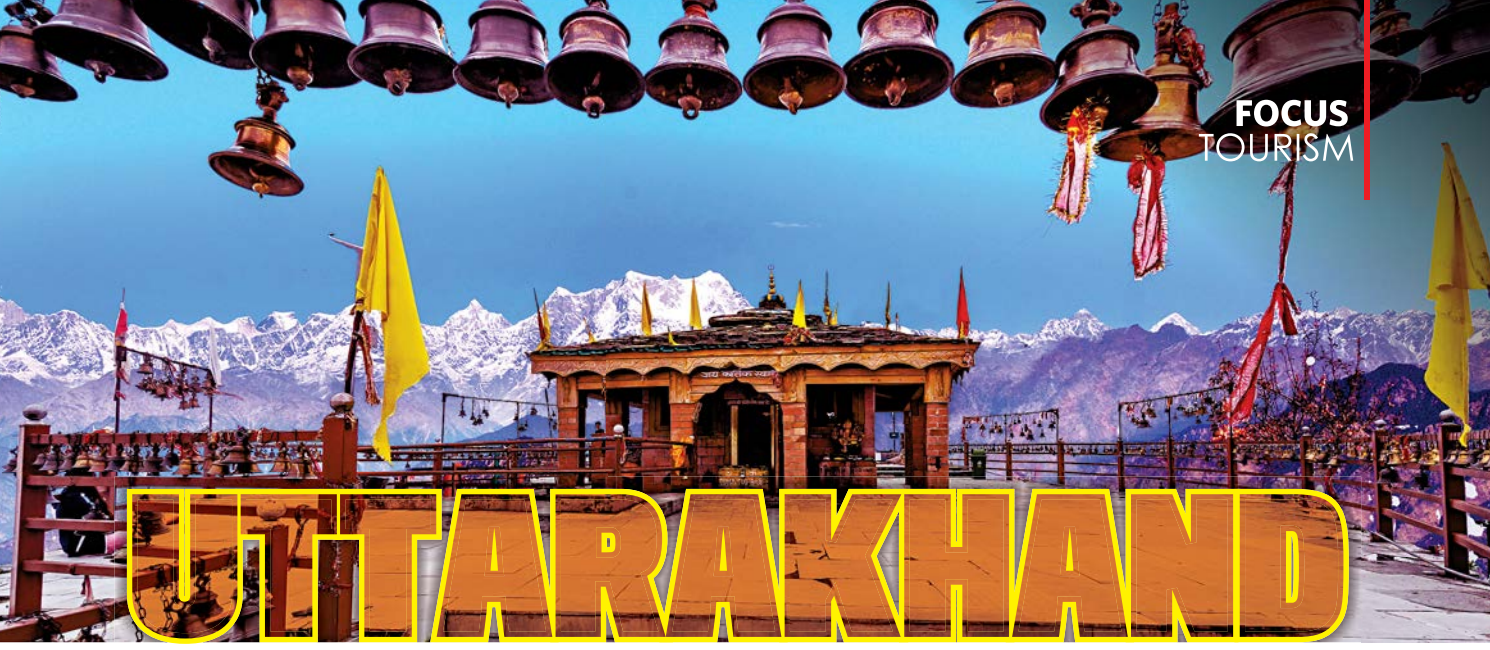


UTTARAKHAND

ABODE OF GODS

Kartik Swami Temple- Shrine of Lord Murugan in the hills

In the wonderlands of the Garhwal Himalayas, lies the Kartik Swami temple that remains hidden by the cottony clouds that carelessly drift above the temple. This holy temple is dedicated to Kartikeya, the elder son of Lord Shiva and is adorned at the end of a narrow ridge, enclosed by a deep valley. Kartik Swami is a temple of mystic ambience and exquisite views.

The popular Hindu temple is perched on a hilltop at an elevation of more than 3000 meters and situated near Kanak Chauri Village in the district of Rudraprayag. In order to reach the temple, one has to undergo a 3 km thrilling trek that starts from Kanak Chauri Village. The route of the trek is rugged but it assures astonishing verdure to relish the exquisiteness of nature.

One can soak in the mystical beauty of the snowy peaks and the lower Himalayas that can be seen from here. The temple holds an immense religious and cultural significance as it is the only shrine in Uttarakhand dedicated to Lord Kartikeya. For those who are not aware of the mythology, Kartikeya was the elder son of Lord Shiva and Goddess Parvati. He is prayed as Skand or Murugun in the south.

Nestled atop the majestic Kronch Parvat, the Kartik Swami Temple stands as a resplendent testament to devotion. Revered as Lord Muruga or Lord Murugan in certain regions of India, Lord Kartik's unwavering devotion to his parents inspires countless devotees who flock to this sacred abode. Beyond the captivating landscapes, the Kartik Swami Temple beckoned us with its architectural splendour. Intricate designs embellished its facade, reflecting the region's rich cultural heritage. It is believed to be the place where Lord Kartikeya displayed his deep devotion by offering his bones to his parents. Another narrative transports us to a time when Lord Shiva and Goddess Parvati tasked their sons, Lord Kartik and Lord Ganesha, with a cosmic odyssey. The divine command entailed circumambulating the universe seven times, symbolising the eternal cycle of creation. Lord Kartik embarked on this expedition, traversing the cosmos with unwavering determination. Meanwhile, Lord Ganesha, recognising the profound truth of the universe in his beloved parents, encircled them seven times, paying homage to their boundless love and guidance. When Lord Kartik returned from his arduous journey, he discovered that his younger brother had triumphed, capturing the admiration of Lord Shiva. Consumed by a surge of fury and resentment, Lord Kartik withdrew from Kailash, the celestial abode of his parents, seeking solace atop the Kronch Parvat. Driven by his tumultuous emotions, Lord Kartik offered his mortal form as a sacrificial gesture upon the hallowed grounds of Kronch Parvat, a poignant act to assuage the turbulence within his being. These timeless legends infuse the Kartik Swami Temple with an aura of mystique, inviting pilgrims to immerse themselves in the sacred tapestry of divine devotion and familial bonds.

To make sure that people know about this historic place, the Uttarakhand Tourism Department has decided to develop the temple to woo tourists and devotees from all over India.

